

We Accept Global Death for Electricity, but AI Crosses the Line?

Posted by u/Zestyclose_Nose_3423 • 0 points • 14 comments

If you're willing to use electricity, despite it being built on global exploitation, fossil fuel deaths, and worker abuse, then on what ethical basis do you draw a hard line against AI, which is simply another product of that same system of exploitation?

>In before trad artists ruin the ethics thread with metaphysical arguments about soul

Comments

u/Elliot-S9 • 3 points • 2025-06-23 19:01 UTC

This is so absurd. Would you give it a break with these boring, awful attempts at analogy. AI is not analogous to past inventions no matter how hard your pea sized brain tries to force it.

AI is not a car or a plow. It's not a printing press or a train. And, no, it's not electricity. They're not similar and comparing them is not deep (unless perhaps you're 14 years old.)

We don't like global warming either obviously. I'm sure the vast majority of us are all for clean energy. What in God's name does this have to do with AI though?

u/Zestyclose_Nose_3423 • 1 points • 2025-06-23 19:18 UTC

"Top 1% commenter" energy is wild when your whole argument boils down to:

> 'Nu-uh, AI is different because... *feelings.*

You say analogies are "boring" and "awful," which is a cute way of admitting you're uncomfortable thinking about systems. Electricity and AI both depend on the same global extractive networks.

And "we're all for clean energy".... great! But you're still on Reddit, powered by dirty energy. You're not off the grid. You're participating. And that's my point, you're not against exploitation, you're just picky about where you notice it.

u/Elliot-S9 • 2 points • 2025-06-23 19:35 UTC

I don't need to prove your analogy incorrect. It's your job to support, explain, and justify your analogy. An analogy is often used in a type of claim or argument, and claims need support or should be discarded.

Obviously AI is nothing like electricity. And the only rationale you can offer is that they both vaguely hurt people. Cool. So does cyanide and bombs. Your point?

I'm not picky about anything. You just assume this is the only subreddit I'm a part of? You just assume my entire life is dedicated to being opposed to AI? Your entire life may be as simple as supporting AI, but don't project that on me.

I'm also anti-consumerist, a socialist, an anti-trump protester, a furious supporter of green energy and land conservation, a former teacher, and in law school for environmental law. So do me a favor and shut up and go back to your tech bro oligarchs. They're waiting for their blowjob.

u/Zestyclose_Nose_3423 • 1 points • 2025-06-23 19:45 UTC

Wow, a whole resume drop and a tech bro insult? You must've hit "Top 1% Commenter" by sheer volume!

Let's untangle the spaghetti here lmao

You don't have to prove the analogy wrong, yet you do write four paragraphs declaring it invalid without doing so. Got it.

You say "AI is nothing like electricity" and follow up with "they both vaguely hurt people." You just reinforced the comparison while trying to reject it.

You invoke cyanide and bombs, so your logic is now: "things that cause harm are incomparable because they cause harm differently"? Bold.

Also, projecting? My guy, I made a post about systemic energy ethics. You wrote a manifesto about how virtuous and angry you are. You dropped "socialist, anti-consumerist, green energy warrior, law student, teacher, and environmental defender" like Pokémon badges, then ended with "go shut up and blow a tech bro."

Tell me you're not mad without telling me you're mad.

u/Elliott-S9 • 2 points • 2025-06-23 21:09 UTC

We get 7 of these threads a day about how the printing press, plow, or camera are the same as AI. It gets really old.

Fine if I really have to explain this to you for some reason, I will. Why I have to is beyond me, but here we go:

1. Electricity was invented a century ago and is completely embedded into every aspect of our lives. The only way to avoid it would be to be Amish. Generative AI is easily avoidable and easy to cut from your life.

2. Electricity causes harm and lots of it, but it also has many real and profound benefits. Generative AI does not.

3. Generative AI poses serious risks to the education system, critical thinking, IQ, and literacy especially in sections of society that are already at risk. Electricity does not.

4. Generative AI poses serious risks to democracies around the world. Electricity does not.

5. The designers of AI seek to create AGI or ASI. While I am highly skeptical that this is possible in the near-term, it is a highly dangerous and reckless concept. While people did worry about the safety of electricity when it was first being implemented, there was never a fear or concern of this magnitude.

This is why they are not analogous. Please find another tactic. Make a claim that could actually change my mind, rather than just trolling or arguing in bad faith.

u/Zestyclose_Nose_3423 • 0 points • 2025-06-23 21:17 UTC

No one's making you, Elliot. You're the one refreshing r/antiai like it's your 9-to-5, writing novellas under every post with "Top 1% Commenter" proudly glowing like a badge in a mobile game. You're here because you need to be right in public. Let's not pretend.

Now let's unpack the latest TED Talk you didn't need to give lmao.

1. Electricity is embedded so it gets a pass?

.... That's not an ethical stance, that's a convenience plea. Saying "well, we can't avoid it" isn't a defense, it's a confession. You've accepted the harm. That's the entire point I made...

2. Electricity has benefits, AI doesn't? What.

Let me guess, you've never seen a paraplegic use AI to speak again or a nonverbal child find expression through generative tools. Because if you had, you wouldn't be making blanket statements like you're the Oracle of Ethics.

3 & 4. AI harms education/democracy more than electricity?

Let's not romanticize electricity. It powers propaganda machines, surveillance states, and yes, the very platforms where critical thinking goes to die. The tools aren't inherently good or bad, it's how they're used. This should be Ethics 101, but here we are top 1% commenter.

5. People weren't afraid of electricity like they are AI.

My brother in lucidity WHAT... people literally thought electricity was witchcraft and refused to let it in their homes. There were public backlashes, bans, and mass fear campaigns. This is history.

You want to pretend I'm trolling because my comparison makes you uncomfortable.

u/Elliot-S9 • 2 points • 2025-06-23 21:25 UTC

Eww. You just responded with chat gpt. And big surprise, none of it makes sense.

We're done. Get your brain rot away from me.

u/Zestyclose_Nose_3423
• 1 points •
2025-06-23
21:30 UTC

Big suprise, when the noob gets dismantled he scurries away with his tail between his legs. See ya later, Top 1%er. NEXT.

u/Ok_Trade_4549 • 3 points • 2025-06-23 17:29 UTC

Our main concerns are far bigger and different, the environmental concerns are just the cherry on top to hating AI

u/HaggisPope • 6 points • 2025-06-23 16:01 UTC

So if I get you right, you're basically saying because all capitalism is bad we should just keep making it worse?

It's certainly an interesting argument.

u/Elliot-S9 • 2 points • 2025-06-23 19:04 UTC

Right? Makes no sense whatsoever. They love these "two wrongs make a right" arguments.

u/Zestyclose_Nose_3423 • -1 points • 2025-06-23 16:26 UTC

No, I'm saying if you're gonna draw a moral line, draw it where the blood is. Electricity, as it currently exists, is responsible for millions of deaths a year. Directly and indirectly. Fossil fuels, grid maintenance, global worker abuse, that is the cost of the lights being on.

u/AuksoOrda • 1 points • 2025-08-01 21:00 UTC

Yeah but like AI also uses energy + is gonna make people lazier.

Also AI and search engines are responsible for shrinking the brains of future generations, because we don't have to think for answers/solutions nearly as often anymore.

u/eeepy_boi • 2 points • 2025-06-23 15:21 UTC

Bruh